

SKILLS GUIDE



Team-working skills for cooperating with other health personnel in emergency situations.



Strong leadership and organizational skills to direct team members during medical crises.



Compassion and empathy when giving emotional support to patients and their families.



Quick-thinking and decision-making skills for responding effectively to emergency situations.



The confidence to carry out emergency procedures quickly in often tough conditions.



High levels of physical fitness to use patient lifting devices and other equipment safely.



CRITICAL CARE

PARAMEDIC Provides advanced care for patients being transported between medical facilities: this may include managing airways, administering drugs, and monitoring signs of life.



RAPID RESPONSE

PARAMEDIC Works as part of a specialized rapid-response team, providing emergency care via a motorcycle, car, or air ambulance (helicopter) unit.

AT A GLANCE



YOUR INTERESTS Health and Medicine • Biology • Chemistry • Physics • Mathematics • English • Helping and caring for others



ENTRY QUALIFICATIONS You must have a CPR certification and complete a training program. All states require paramedics to be licensed.



LIFESTYLE Working hours are regular but usually involve shifts, covering nights, weekends, and public holidays.



LOCATION Based at a hospital or an ambulance station, paramedics travel to emergencies and spend a lot of time on the road.



THE REALITIES The work is physically tough and can be emotionally draining. Accident sites are often harrowing, so you need to keep calm and focused.

RELATED CAREERS

► **FIREFIGHTER** *see pp. 248–249*

► **MEDICAL DOCTOR** *see pp. 276–277*

► **NURSE** *see pp. 278–279*

► **MIDWIFE** *see pp. 280–281*

► **AMBULANCE CARE ASSISTANT** Moves disabled, elderly, or vulnerable people to and from health clinics, and for routine hospital admissions.

